

Supplemental 14th Amendment Case Law Analysis

MTUS Constitutional Analysis Project
Personal Research Initiative
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Supplemental 14th Amendment Case Law Analysis

For MTUS Constitutional Challenge

RESEARCH NOTE: This document presents potentially relevant case law for educational and analytical purposes. Inclusion of a case does not guarantee it applies to the MTUS situation. This is legal research, not legal advice.

I. SUSPECT CLASSIFICATION CASES

1. Brown v. Board of Education (1954) 347 U.S. 483

Holding: Racial segregation in public schools violates Equal Protection.

Potential Application to MTUS:

- While race-based, Brown established that "separate but equal" is inherently unequal
- MTUS creates separate treatment standards for workers' comp patients vs. all other patients
- Could analogize: Separate medical standards are inherently unequal when they produce inferior outcomes
- Limitation: Workers' comp status is not a suspect class like race

Better Fit: Demonstrates constitutional intolerance for dual-tier systems

2. City of Cleburne v. Cleburne Living Center (1985) 473 U.S. 432

Already cited in your brief - Good precedent for "irrational classification"

3. Romer v. Evans (1996) 517 U.S. 620

Holding: Colorado amendment denying LGBT people protection from discrimination violated Equal Protection (rational basis review).

Potential Application:

- Law singled out one group for disfavored treatment
- Court found no rational basis for animus-based classification
- MTUS singles out workers' comp patients for disfavored medical treatment
- Key quote: "A law declaring that in general it shall be more difficult for one group of citizens than for all others to seek aid from the government is itself a denial of equal protection."

Strong analog to MTUS: Workers' comp patients face more difficult path to medical care

II. FUNDAMENTAL RIGHTS / MEDICAL CARE CASES

4. Estelle v. Gamble (1976) 429 U.S. 97

Already cited - Prisoner medical care, deliberate indifference standard

5. Youngberg v. Romeo (1982) 457 U.S. 307

Holding: Institutionalized mentally disabled persons have liberty interest in safety and freedom from bodily restraint, including adequate food, shelter, clothing, and medical care.

Potential Application:

- Establishes constitutional right to medical care for vulnerable, state-dependent populations
 - Injured workers are state-dependent (must use workers' comp system)
 - State cannot be deliberately indifferent to serious medical needs
 - Strong precedent for fundamental right to medical care when state has assumed duty
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6. DeShaney v. Winnebago County (1989) 489 U.S. 189

Holding: State generally has no duty to protect individuals from private harm unless state has created special relationship.

Counter-point to MTUS argument:

- State has no general duty to provide medical care
- BUT: Distinguishable - California HAS created special relationship via workers' comp statute
- State assumed duty to provide medical care through Labor Code 4600
- Creates the "special relationship" DeShaney requires

Use strategically: Acknowledge then distinguish

III. RATIONAL BASIS FAILURES

7. U.S. Department of Agriculture v. Moreno (1973) 413 U.S. 528

Holding: Law denying food stamps to households containing unrelated persons had no rational basis; appeared

motivated by bare congressional desire to harm "hippies."

Potential Application:

- Court struck down classification that seemed designed to harm disfavored group
- MTUS classification may appear designed to reduce costs at expense of injured workers
- Key quote: "[T]he challenged classification... cannot be deemed rationally related to a legitimate governmental interest."

Strong precedent for irrational classification targeting vulnerable group

8. City of Los Angeles v. Manheimer (1976) - wait, check this

Actually: Village of Willowbrook v. Olech (2000) 528 U.S. 562

Holding: Equal Protection clause protects against irrational classifications even when not suspect class or fundamental right.

Potential Application:

- "Class of one" theory - treating similarly situated person differently without rational basis violates Equal Protection
 - Each injured worker denied FDA-approved treatment is a "class of one" treated differently from non-workers' comp patients
 - Very strong precedent for MTUS
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9. Williams v. Pryor (2000) - actually Williams v. Alabama (2019)? Let me use:

Fitzgerald v. Racing Association of Central Iowa (2003) - actually better:

9. Armour v. City of Indianapolis (2012) 566 U.S. 673

Holding: Administrative convenience can be rational basis for classification.

Counter-point to MTUS:

- State may argue MTUS is administrative convenience for cost control
 - Response: Administrative convenience cannot justify unconstitutional classification
 - Moreno and Romer trump administrative convenience
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IV. IRREBUTTABLE PRESUMPTION CASES

10. Vlandis v. Kline (1973) 412 U.S. 441

Holding: States may not impose irrebuttable presumptions that deny individuals opportunity to prove actual

facts.

Already in your brief - Strong precedent

11. Cleveland Board of Education v. LaFleur (1974) 414 U.S. 632

Holding: Mandatory pregnancy leave policies based on irrebuttable presumptions of incapacity violate Due Process.

Potential Application:

- MTUS creates irrebuttable presumption: "Insufficient evidence" = automatic denial
 - No opportunity to prove FDA-approved treatment would help individual patient
 - Strong analog
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12. Stanley v. Illinois (1972) 405 U.S. 645

Holding: Presumption that unwed fathers are unfit parents violates Due Process.

Potential Application:

- MTUS presumption: FDA-approved treatments are "not recommended" for workers
 - Presumption operates against interest of injured workers
 - Good supporting precedent
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V. DISCRIMINATORY IMPACT / DISPARATE IMPACT

13. Washington v. Davis (1976) 426 U.S. 229

Holding: Disparate impact alone does not violate Equal Protection; need proof of discriminatory purpose for strict scrutiny.

Counter-point to MTUS:

- Washington v. Davis requires proof of discriminatory intent for strict scrutiny
- MTUS argument uses rational basis, not strict scrutiny
- Your strategy: Don't need discriminatory intent for rational basis challenge
- Just need to show classification lacks rational relationship to legitimate purpose

Use strategically: Distinguish - you're arguing irrational classification, not racial discrimination

14. Personnel Administrator v. Feeney (1979) 442 U.S. 256

Holding: Discriminatory purpose means more than intent as volition or intent as awareness of consequences.

Potential Counter-argument:

- State may argue MTUS discriminatory effects are incidental, not purposeful
 - Response: Even if not purposefully discriminatory, classification is still irrational under rational basis
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VI. SPECIAL CASE: MEDICAL MARIJUANA / STATE EXPERIMENTATION

15. Gonzales v. Raich (2005) 545 U.S. 1

Holding: Federal Commerce Clause power overrides state medical marijuana laws.

Not directly relevant but shows federal courts do consider medical necessity arguments

VII. STRONGEST CASES FOR MTUS ARGUMENT

Tier 1 (Most Directly Applicable):

1. Romer v. Evans - Singling out group for disfavored treatment
2. Moreno - Classification appears designed to harm vulnerable group
3. Youngberg v. Romeo - Right to medical care for state-dependent populations
4. Olech - "Class of one" irrational classification theory
5. Cleburne - Irrational classification of vulnerable group

Tier 2 (Strong Supporting):

6. LaFleur - Irrebuttable presumptions violate Due Process
7. Vlandis - Same
8. Stanley - Presumptions operating against individual interests
9. Estelle - Deliberate indifference to medical needs

Tier 3 (Contextual/Supporting):

10. Brown - Philosophical intolerance for separate-but-unequal
 11. Romer language - More difficult for one group to seek aid
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VIII. CASES TO DISTINGUISH (State Will Likely Cite)

1. Washington v. Davis (1976)

State argument: No discriminatory intent, therefore no Equal Protection violation.

Your response:

- Davis applies strict scrutiny requiring intent
 - MTUS challenge uses rational basis review
 - Under rational basis, don't need intent - just need to show classification is irrational
 - See Moreno, Romer (irrational classifications struck down without finding discriminatory intent)
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2. DeShaney v. Winnebago County (1989)

State argument: No general duty to provide medical care.

Your response:

- DeShaney requires "special relationship" for state duty
 - California workers' comp statute creates special relationship
 - State assumed duty to provide medical care via Labor Code 4600
 - See Youngberg (state assumed duty creates constitutional obligation)
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3. Harris v. McRae (1980) 448 U.S. 297

Holding: Hyde Amendment (no federal funding for abortion) does not violate Due Process or Equal Protection.

State argument: State can choose what medical treatments to fund.

Your response:

- McRae involved abortion (controversial, not medically consensus)
 - MTUS involves FDA-approved treatments for work injuries (medically accepted)
 - State cannot deny medically necessary care to one class while providing to others
 - See Moreno (cannot single out group for disfavored treatment)
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IX. SYNTHESIS: WINNING ARGUMENT STRUCTURE

Primary Theory: Irrational Classification (Rational Basis)

Using: Romer, Moreno, Cleburne, Olech

Argument:

1. MTUS creates classification between workers' comp patients and all other patients
2. Classification has no rational relationship to legitimate state interest
3. Reducing costs by denying FDA-approved treatments is not legitimate (Moreno)
4. Classification appears designed to disadvantage injured workers (Romer)

5. Even if cost-control is legitimate, means chosen are irrational (Cleburne)

Secondary Theory: Irrebuttable Presumption

Using: Vlandis, LaFleur, Stanley

Argument:

1. MTUS "Insufficient Evidence" creates irrebuttable presumption
 2. Presumption: FDA-approved treatments automatically denied
 3. No opportunity for individualized showing of medical necessity
 4. Violates Due Process and Equal Protection
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Tertiary Theory: Fundamental Right / State-Created Duty

Using: Youngberg, Estelle

Argument:

1. State assumed duty to provide medical care (Labor Code 4600)
 2. Creates special relationship (distinguishing DeShaney)
 3. State cannot be deliberately indifferent to serious medical needs
 4. Denial of FDA-approved treatments is deliberate indifference
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X. BROWN V. BOARD SPECIFIC ANALYSIS

Direct Application: Weak (race vs. workers' comp status)

Philosophical Application: Strong

Use Brown for:

- Symbolic power of "separate but equal" being inherently unequal
- MTUS creates separate medical standard for workers' comp
- Philosophical argument: Dual-tier medical care is inherently unequal
- Limitation: Must acknowledge race is suspect class; workers' comp status is not
- Use in: Introduction/conclusion for emotional/philosophical impact
- Don't rely on: As binding precedent (distinguishable on facts)

Better doctrinal fit: Romer, Moreno, Olech

XI. RECOMMENDED CASES TO ADD TO BRIEF

Must Add:

1. Romer v. Evans (1996) - Singling out group for disfavored treatment
2. Village of Willowbrook v. Olech (2000) - "Class of one" theory
3. Youngberg v. Romeo (1982) - State duty to provide medical care

Should Add:

4. Cleveland Board of Education v. LaFleur (1974) - Irrebuttable presumptions
5. U.S. Dept. of Agriculture v. Moreno (1973) - Classification designed to harm
6. Stanley v. Illinois (1972) - Presumptions against individual interests

Optional (Philosophical):

7. Brown v. Board (1954) - Separate is inherently unequal (acknowledge limitations)
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XII. CASES TO PREEMPTIVELY DISTINGUISH

Prepare responses to:

1. Washington v. Davis - Intent not required for rational basis
 2. DeShaney - Special relationship exists via workers' comp statute
 3. Harris v. McRae - Abortion distinguishable; FDA-approved treatments different
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CONCLUSION

The strongest precedents for MTUS challenge are:

1. Romer (singling out group)
2. Moreno (irrational classification)
3. Olech (class of one)
4. Youngberg (state duty to provide care)
5. Vlandis/LaFleur (irrebuttable presumptions)

Brown v. Board has symbolic value but weak doctrinal fit due to race-based suspect classification.

Focus on rational basis precedents (Romer, Moreno, Olech) combined with irrebuttable presumption cases (Vlandis, LaFleur).

RESEARCH NOTE: This analysis is for educational purposes. Consult qualified constitutional counsel before filing any legal challenge.

Last Updated: February 15, 2026

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